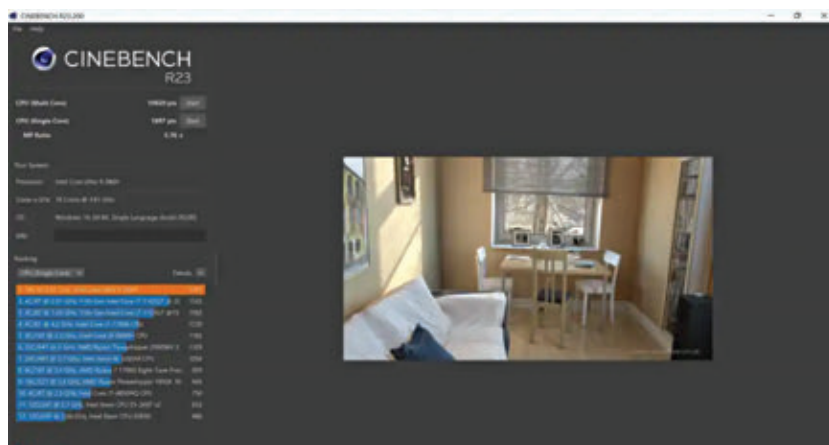




a nice addition but also a necessary one. As for the feel and build of the keyboard, the keys here come quite close to what you get on a MacBook, even though the design is different. You also get a clean backlight here, which helps if you're working late. And it's actually quite bright. I could clearly see it even while sitting at my desk during the day.

Below the keyboard is the trackpad, which is just the right size for casual use. Coming from a MacBook Air 15, I definitely am used to a much larger trackpad, but the one on the Zenbook S14 also didn't feel adequate. However, the clicks here feel fine, but not premium, as this isn't a haptic trackpad.

Coming to the speakers, you get a quad setup with Dolby Atmos. They do get loud, no doubt. But the clarity is not quite there. The sound feels a bit flat, especially when you're watching movies or gaming. Basically, if you really care about audio quality, you'll probably end up using headphones most of the time.

PORTS AND OTHER FEATURES

For a laptop this thin, the port selection is quite solid on the Asus Zenbook S14.

You get a USB Type-A port, two Thunderbolt 4 ports, an HDMI 2.1 port,

and a headphone jack. In my usage, these ports were just enough. You also get Windows facial recognition, and this works really well. It's fast, accurate, and unlocks the laptop almost instantly.

The front camera is decent and gets the job done for video calls. But at this price, I expected better. When I turned on background blur, the edge detection wasn't perfect. My hair kept blending into the background. Moreover, there is some noise in the picture quality the moment you turn the camera on.

EVERYDAY PERFORMANCE

My unit of the Asus Zenbook S14 is powered by the Intel Core Ultra 9 386H processor, paired with 32GB RAM. And simply put, this combination is fast.

There are instant app launches, and even with multiple apps running together, the laptop doesn't slow down.

This real-world performance is backed by strong benchmark numbers.

Now this is not a gaming laptop. But being an avid gamer, I did try some gaming on this, and I wasn't disappointed. Lighter titles like Overcooked 2 and Phasmophobia ran smoothly without any issues. I even tried pushing it with heavier games like Forza Horizon

5 and Doom: The Dark Ages. With lower graphics settings, they were playable.

But of course, if you absolutely give it the beans, the integrated GPU starts showing its limits. So yes, you can game on this laptop. But it's more of a bonus.

BATTERY AND THERMALS

As it is with Zenbooks, the strongest point here is once again, the battery life. In the PC Mark battery test, the laptop lasted for 14 hours. And this is when it was set to the best performance mode. When I set the laptop to the best power efficiency mode, it lasted a full 18 hours,

So, the battery life here is not just reliable, but excellent. You don't need to panic if you forget your charger on one of those crazy Monday mornings.

Thermals are also well managed here. There are vents along the chassis that help push heat out, and they seem to be doing their job well. The fans do kick in, but you won't hear any noise.

During normal use, the laptop stays cool. And even when I pushed it with benchmarks and heavier tasks, it only got slightly warm, not uncomfortable.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The Asus Zenbook S14 is a laptop that gets a lot right. It looks like it was built for business, is super convenient to carry around, and comes with strong performance. The battery life and display are top-notch, and the experience is extremely polished. At this price point, you start noticing the small things.

—Divyanshi Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 9 386H | Neural Processor: Intel NPU up to 49 TOPS | Display: 14-inch 3K OLED panel | Brightness: 1,100 nits | RAM: 32 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 1TB M.2 NVMe PCIe 4.0 | Camera: FHD Camera with IR | Battery: 77 WHrs | Power Supply: 68W AC Adapter

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